

English Language · Harder paper

Real VCAA questions ranked by the published state results. Editable: type your answers straight into this PDF, save it, then mark yourself with the guide at the back.

Name _____ Date _____

75 marks

reading 15 min · writing 120 min

State average on these questions

39 / 75 (53%)

a student at the state average on every question

How to use this paper

1. Open each question with its blue link. It opens the official VCAA exam PDF at the right page. The question text isn't reproduced here because it is VCAA copyright (some exams include third-party material).
2. Answer in this file: click a bubble for multiple choice, and type in the boxes for written answers (long answers scroll inside the box). Methods and science working can be typed in plain text, e.g. $v = \sqrt{2gh} = 9.9 \text{ m/s}$.
3. Keep to the real time limits above, and don't look at the guide until you've finished.
4. Save with Ctrl/Cmd + S. Use a PDF app that supports forms: Adobe Acrobat Reader, Chrome, Edge, Firefox, macOS Preview or Xodo.
5. Mark yourself: in the guide at the back, tick each marking point you earned, enter your marks, and compare your total with the state average.

Why these questions

Every section is a real VCAA exam section. English sections can't be split question by question, because each is built around one text, so Sections A, B and C from the 2023, 2024 and 2025 exams were ranked by state average and this paper takes the lowest-scored version of each section. English results barely move between years, so the three English papers are close in difficulty. VCAA reports Sections B and C on a 0–15 scale, so the averages are doubled to match the 30 marks on the paper.

Sources

- [2023 English Language exam \(PDF\)](#) · [examiners' report](#) (*previous study design*)

Section A – Short-answer questions (15 marks)

All questions refer to Text 1 in the insert of the 2023 exam. Open the insert and each question with the links.

Section A (15 marks)

2023 VCAA exam · Insert, Text 1 · [previous study design](#) · [open in the official exam PDF \(p. 24\)](#) ↗

Text 1: a community newsletter from Melbourne Airport about its expansion plans

Question 1. Identify one semantic field/domain of the discourse and give two supporting examples with line numbers. ([p. 2](#) ↗) (2 marks)

Question 2. Discuss the function of two different syntactic features used between lines 43 and 70 (examples, metalanguage). ([p. 3](#) ↗) (4 marks)

Question 3. Analyse two features that contribute to the coherence of the text (metalanguage, line numbers). ([p. 3](#) ↗) (4 marks)

Question 4. How does the register support two social purposes of the text? (examples, line numbers, metalanguage) (p. 4 ↗) (5 marks)

Section B – Analytical commentary (30 marks)

Write an analytical commentary on Text 2 in the insert of the 2023 exam: function, purpose and intent; situational and cultural context; register, tenor and audience; and relevant language features from at least two subsystems.

Section B (30 marks)

2023 VCAA exam · Section B · Question 5 · [open in the official exam PDF \(p. 5\)](#) ↗

Insert: [Text 2](#) ↗

Text 2: a transcript of an interview on a national evening radio show

Analytical commentary on Text 2 (30 marks)

Section C – Essay (30 marks)

Write one essay on one of the three topics. Open the topic in the official exam for the exact wording and stimulus material.

Section C (30 marks)

2023 VCAA exam · Section C (choose one of Questions 6, 7, 8) · [previous study design](#) · [open in the official exam PDF \(p. 13\)](#) ↗

Choose one topic.

1. **Question 6.** To what extent do the Australian Englishes heard in advertising and entertainment represent the Englishes spoken in contemporary Australia? ([exact wording and stimulus, p. 13](#) ↗)
2. **Question 7.** How far do changing societal and community attitudes determine the language choices people make? ([exact wording and stimulus, p. 14](#) ↗)
3. **Question 8.** Language as a tool that can both build and destroy relationships: discuss. ([exact wording and stimulus, p. 15](#) ↗)

Essay (name the topic you chose) (30 marks)

Essay (name the topic you chose) continued

END OF PAPER

Marking guide follows

Stop here until you have finished the paper under exam conditions.

Marking guide

Section A – Short-answer questions (15 marks)

Section A (15 marks) · state average 6.6 / 15 (44%)

2023 VCAA exam · Insert, Text 1

Question 1 · Identify one semantic field/domain of the discourse and give two supporting examples with line numbers.

- ☐ Identifies a valid semantic field (e.g. aviation, government, infrastructure, sustainability)
- ☐ Two supporting examples with line numbers and metalanguage (e.g. noun phrases “carbon emissions”, 20; “circular economy principles”, 21)

Answer / notes: Sustainability: the noun phrases “carbon emissions” (20) and “circular economy principles” (21). Label the word class or phrase type.

State average 1.1 / 2 (55%); 29% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 23% · 1: 48% · 2: 29%

Your mark: _____ / 2

Question 2 · Discuss the function of two different syntactic features used between lines 43 and 70 (examples, metalanguage).

- ☐ First syntactic feature accurately identified with an example (e.g. sentence fragment, line 69)
- ☐ Its function explained
- ☐ Second, different feature identified with an example (e.g. declaratives, listing, parallelism, ellipsis)
- ☐ Its function explained

Answer / notes: The fragment “Timeline subject to approval” (69) signals provisional information concisely. Declaratives (63–65) state construction dates clearly, serving the informative function. Check sentence-type labels carefully.

State average 1.5 / 4 (38%); 7% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 25% · 1: 24% · 2: 33% · 3: 12% · 4: 7%

Your mark: _____ / 4

Question 3 · Analyse two features that contribute to the coherence of the text (metalanguage, line numbers).

- ☐ First coherence feature identified (e.g. formatting: bold, centred headings)
- ☐ Explains how it creates coherence (e.g. lets readers navigate to relevant sections)
- ☐ Second feature identified (e.g. logical ordering, conventions, consistent semantic field, inference)
- ☐ Explains how it creates coherence

Answer / notes: “Analyse” means explaining how each feature helps the reader make sense of the text, not just labelling it. Cohesive ties count only if linked to coherence.

State average 1.9 / 4 (48%); 7% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 9% · 1: 23% · 2: 41% · 3: 21% · 4: 7%

Your mark: _____ / 4

Question 4 · How does the register support two social purposes of the text? (examples, line numbers, metalanguage)

- ☐ Identifies the predominantly formal register
- ☐ Example 1 with metalanguage
- ☐ Social purpose 1 linked (e.g. establishing authority or expertise)
- ☐ Example 2 with metalanguage
- ☐ Social purpose 2 linked (e.g. building rapport with the community, clarifying project details)

Answer / notes: Formal register lends authority and expertise, and clarifies project details for the community. Link each purpose directly to formality rather than dwelling on minor informal touches.

State average 2.1 / 5 (42%); 2% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 8% · 1: 23% · 2: 33% · 3: 25% · 4: 9% · 5: 2%

Your mark: _____ / 5

Section B – Analytical commentary (30 marks)

Section B (30 marks) · state average 16.4 / 30 (55%)

2023 VCAA exam · Section B · Question 5

Analytical commentary on Text 2

____ / 8 · Function(s), purpose(s) and intent(s), situational and cultural context, and register, tenor and audience are analysed accurately and specifically for this text

____ / 10 · Salient language features from at least two subsystems are analysed with quoted examples and line numbers, each explicitly linked to function, context or register

____ / 6 · Precise, accurate metalanguage throughout

____ / 6 · A coherent, sustained commentary (not a feature list), with clear, controlled expression

Answer / notes: Mostly informal, casual register for a spoken interview: conventional interview openings and formulaic questions alongside unusually warm, familiar rapport between the presenter and guest. Analyse background-setting for listeners, entertainment and music lexis, and mutual admiration beyond the expected interviewer–interviewee dynamic.

State average 16.4 / 30 (55%). VCAA reports this section on a 0–15 scale (doubled here to /30): 0: 0.5% · 1: 0.5% · 2: 0.5% · 3: 1% · 4: 2% · 5: 3% · 6: 8% · 7: 16% · 8: 25% · 9: 23% · 10: 13% · 11: 5% · 12: 2% · 13: 1% · 14: 0.5% · 15: 0.5%

Your mark: ____ / 30

Section C – Essay (30 marks)

Section C (30 marks) · state average 16.4 / 30 (55%)

2023 VCAA exam · Section C (choose one of Questions 6, 7, 8)

Essay (name the topic you chose)

____ / 8 · A clear, sustained and nuanced contention that answers the exact wording of the topic (including “to what extent” where asked)

____ / 10 · Relevant, contemporary Australian examples discussed in depth, drawing on at least two subsystems of language, with thoughtful use of the stimulus

____ / 6 · Accurate linguistic concepts and metalanguage

____ / 6 · Cohesive essay structure and fluent, controlled expression

Answer / notes: Unpack every key word of the topic in the introduction, and blend the stimulus with your own contemporary examples rather than quoting large chunks of it.

State average 16.4 / 30 (55%). VCAA reports this section on a 0–15 scale (doubled here to /30): 0: 1% · 1: 0.5% · 2: 0.5% · 3: 1% · 4: 2% · 5: 5% · 6: 10% · 7: 15% · 8: 21% · 9: 20% · 10: 13% · 11: 7% · 12: 3% · 13: 1% · 14: 0.5% · 15: 0.5%

Your mark: ____ / 30

Your result

Total: _____ / 75 State average on these questions: **39 / 75 (53%)**

Topics to revise:

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